

New Generation English B· Diagnostic Test

B1 (Intermediate Strong) B· Listening

LISTENING

Podcast interview: City Things, with urban beekeeper Olga

Script:

Host: Welcome back to City Things. Today we are talking to Olga, who has been an urban beekeeper in Moscow for almost six years. Olga, thank you for joining us. Many of our listeners are surprised that beekeeping is even possible in a city.

Olga: I understand the surprise. When I started in 2020, my own family thought I was joking. But honestly, the bees do not care that they are in Moscow. They care about flowers, water and a calm hive entrance. All three are available on a rooftop near the Garden Ring.

Host: What was the hardest part of the first year?

Olga: Two things. The first was technical — I had read several books, but books cannot show you how a swarm sounds at six in the morning. The second was social. Some neighbours were nervous about the bees. I learned to talk to them carefully, to invite them up, to show that the hive was calm. After two seasons, no one complained.

Host: And what surprised you most?

Olga: That the bees changed me more than I changed the rooftop. I used to think faster was always better. Now I think faster is sometimes just louder. Beekeeping teaches you to slow down without becoming passive.

1. How long has Olga been an urban beekeeper?

- A) About two years.
- B) Almost six years.**
- C) More than ten years.

2. What did Olga's family initially think?

- A) That she was joking.**
- B) That she was wasting money.
- C) That she had moved abroad.

3. What three things, according to Olga, do bees actually care about?

- A) Flowers, water and a calm hive entrance.**
- B) Quiet neighbours, sun and grass.
- C) Music, water and warm air.

4. What were the two hardest things in her first year?

- A) Money and weather.
- B) Something technical and something social.**
- C) Family and noise.

